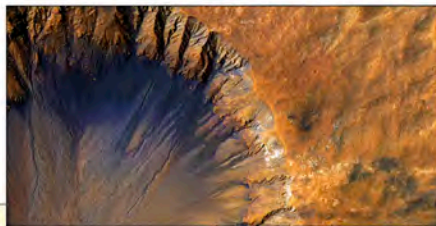


Antenna

Satellite dish

The color test card checks that the camera shows the correct colors.

This container is for soil samples.



Surface of Mars

Other spacecraft have been to Mars since the Viking missions. This image of a huge crater was taken in 2015 by the Mars Reconnaissance Orbiter.

Red desert

Mars is very cold. It has lots of dead volcanoes, craters and dried-up rivers. It looks like a rusty, rocky desert.

Weather instruments

Landing shock absorber

Leggy landers

The Viking spacecraft took about a year to reach Mars. The landers tested soil and sent pictures back to Earth.

The landing feet have rounded pads to stop the legs from digging into the soft soil.